The EDI-as-API Platform

Customer Onboarding Guide

https://zenbridge.io

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The purpose of this document is to help you understand what end-to-end EDI integration using the Zenbridge platform looks like.

This document gives you a comprehensive view into each of the **6 steps** that drive your project from start to go-live.

At the end of this document, you will be able to understand each of these steps, their purpose and how you will be guided by Zenbridge team.

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01 Customer Onboarding

Assigning a BA to your account

The Business Analyst is your single point of contact from Zenbridge to make interaction as easy as possible for you.

Your BA is an EDI expert who can read and interpret EDI specifications and answer EDI queries.

Your BA understands your project scope and its requirements.

The BA interacts with trading partners on your behalf throughout the integration cycle. And they will be the point of contact for the Trading Partner as well.

The BA will communicate with you on a timely basis, to provide you with updates and guidance on how to use the platform.

You can communicate to your BA, any feedback, additional requirements and billing related queries.

The BA ensures your EDI journey is as smooth as possible.

Signing Project Scope and SLA document

The requirements & pricing discussed in the sales call is detailed into a Project Scope & Pricing document.

Your BA will prepare this document and share it with you along with Zenbridge's SLA document via DocuSign.

You are required to review the documents and send us back the signed documents via DocuSign.

Onboarding Call & Project Kick off

An Onboarding Call is organised at your convenient date and time by the Sales manager you interacted with.

The Sales Manager introduces you to your BA.

The main purpose of this call is to align on the scope, requirements, timeline, and any other information that is necessary for the integration.

The BA will walk you through some of the common onboarding questions to populate the onboarding questionnaire that we internally maintain.

This session allows everyone on the call to be on the same page and brings to light any open questions or identifies additional needs/ requirements.

02 Establishing Connection with Trading Partners

Exchanging EDI Connection details

This is the very first step in the integration project with your Trading Partner.

Exchanging Connection Parameters is basically like exchanging contact information to be able to send and receive (EDI) messages.

Your BA will contact your Trading Partner, and collect their EDI Connection parameters.

Zenbridge, will create connection parameters for you and your BA will share this with your Trading Partner.

Connection parameters will vary depending on the connection protocol (type) that is used.

This process allows Zenbridge to drop EDI files in your Trading Partners' inbox and your Trading Partner can share EDI files back with Zenbridge for you.

Setting up Partners on the platform

Once the Trading Partners' connection parameters are collected, the BA adds the Trading Partner and their connection parameters into the Zenbridge platform.

This step instructs the platform, *which* connection to use for sending EDI messages to the particular Trading Partner.

Connection Testing

Both parties confirm that the other's connection parameters are setup on their respective ends.

The BA initiates connection testing, by sending a test file to the Trading Partner's inbox, and requests the Trading Partner to send one back.

When both parties confirm that they are able to send/receive test files to their Test and Production inboxes, it is confirmed that EDI connection is established.

The Test connection is used for exchanging Test files during the Testing phase, and the Production connection is used for exchanging LIVE files on going live.

03 Configuring EDI Specifications

Collecting EDI Specifications

EDI Specification documents act as a guideline for the EDIs in scope. The EDIs must respect the semantic rules and business/ transactional rules specified in it.

Either your EDI Specification or your Trading Partners' can be followed depending on the business arrangement/relationship. This is usually determined in the Onboarding Call.

Your BA will collect the necessary EDI Specification documents for the EDIs in scope either from you or your Trading Partner.

The EDI Specification document is reviewed by the BA and the special instructions in the documents are duly noted.

This step is optional.

Writing EDI Specs for the customer

There are cases where the customer and the Trading Partner may not have EDI Specification documents of their own. In such cases, Zenbridge will design spec documents for the customer.

This typically happens when the customer and/or the Trading Partner is new to EDI and this is their first EDI project. This is assessed in the Onboarding Call.

The BA will be responsible for creating the spec documents. To do this, the BA will begin by asking the customer, what data points they would like to capture in the EDI.

The BA would then design a spec around the data points. The customer is given a walkthrough of the spec to review and freeze it.

This spec is then shared with the Trading Partner by the BA. The Trading Partner can reach out to the BA for questions on the document.

You can then reuse these spec documents with your future Trading Partners in cases where they fail to have one of their own.

Configuring EDI Specifications on the Platform

The EDI Specifications for all the EDIs in scope are configured into Zenbridge platform by the BA.

Configuring simply means, setting up the EDI rules stated in the document onto the machinery.

This configuration process, creates the list of validations and checks that the platform will perform on all inbound and outbound EDIs.

All outbound EDIs have to clear these checks before it is sent out to the Trading Partner. Similarly, any inbound EDI from the Trading Partner has to clear these checks for it to be accepted by Zenbridge, before it can be passed onto you.

This is a critical step in the integration process and ensures good quality EDIs are both received and sent out brining errors down to zero.

04 Defining Workflows & API Doc Generation

Defining Workflows

A Workflow represents the end-to-end flow of EDIs between 2 parties. It basically specifies in what sequence the EDIs in scope are exchanged between the parties involved.

The order or sequence of the EDIs is determined on the Onboarding Call. But, this information is set up on the platform only after EDI specifications are configured.

The BA is responsible for workflow construction in the platform.

Basically what this step does is, it lets the platform know which EDI precedes which, the direction of the EDI file (inbound/outbound), and which EDI spec is used by each EDI Doc.

Further, constructing the workflow, is the input for the API Docs for each of the EDI documents in scope.

API Doc Generation & Walkthrough

The platform generates API Docs for the EDIs in scope based on the workflow constructed.

Your API Developer must refer to these API Docs to generate EDI data in JSON format (for *outbound files*). Similarly, they can understand how to validate the inbound JSON data from Zenbridge (for *inbound files*).

Once API Docs are generated, your API Developer is given an API walkthrough to help her/him understand where to locate the documentation and how to read it.

Typically a Zenbridge technical person along with the BA is present on the API Walkthrough call, to provide maximum guidance to your API Developer.

The API Docs are made available under the API Doc section of the Zenbridge dashboard.

Custom Integration Services

For customers who do not have the capability to perform API integration, Zenbridge offers integration services.

Zenbridge's API Developer will be responsible for the integration.

Developer access to your ERP needs to be provided to the API developer. The developer reads through your ERP's API documentation, to perform the integration.

As part of the integration a mapping document is prepared for mapping the data in your ERP to the elements in the EDI.

This step is optional.

05 Testing using the Sandbox Environment

Accessing the Sandbox environment

You and your API developer are given access to the Sandbox environment of your Zenbridge dashboard.

You can login to the dashboard using the login credentials, which your BA will share with you.

You will receive a separate email with your login credentials.

Setting up Webhook URLs

Zenbridge uses Webhooks to connect to your ERP. Webhook is a callback mechanism using which one application can communicate the events happening inside it to another application.

Webhook URLs act like the phone number of the receiving application (your ERP) which the sending application (Zenbridge) will contact when an event (inbound file is received) occurs.

Your API Developer should provide the Webhook URL to your ERP for each inbound file. This is so that, Zenbridge can call this Webhook URL to pass incoming EDI data to your ERP.

Viewing Test Transactions

Once your API Developer and Trading Partner start testing EDIs, the test transactions will appear in the Transactions page of your dashboard.

Test files are exchanged using the Test connection we set up with your Trading Partner initially.

06 Move-To-Production & Production Support

Go-Live Readiness

Upon successful completion and sign off of EDI Testing, by your API Developer and the Trading Partner, a Go-live date is mutually agreed.

Your BA needs to be kept informed of the same. The go-live intimation needs to be provided to your BA at least 2 days prior to the planned go-live date.

Accessing the Production environment

You and your API developer are given access to the Production environment of your Zenbridge dashboard.

You can login to the dashboard using the login credentials, which your BA will share with you.

You will receive a separate email with your login credentials.

Your API Developer should provide the Webhook URL to your ERP for each inbound file. This is so that, Zenbridge can call this Webhook URL to pass incoming EDI data to your ERP.

Go-Live and Support

LIVE transactions will appear in the Transactions page of your dashboard.

All the configurations (Partners and Connections, Spec, Workflows, API Docs) you see in your Sandbox will also be visible in the Production environment.

Production files are exchanged using the Production connection we set up with your Trading Partner initially.

Production Transactions are closely monitored by your BA for the first week. In cases of file failures, you can reach out to your BA directly who will respond within 24 hours and for responses within 12 hours you can email us at support@zenbridge.io.

Where failures are traced back to the Trading Partner, your BA will reach out to the Trading Partner and facilitate issue resolution.

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